



CRISPR for the womb
Researchers have begun exploring a technique to enable gene editing in the womb. <https://digit.in/may19-35>



Helvetica Now gets a facelift
The most popular typeface in the world is getting reworked. How different will it be? <https://digit.in/may19-36>

the country-wise in-app expenditure, India is nowhere in the top five.

When it comes to games, India has a slightly different story to tell. While its in-game purchases rank nowhere among the top contenders, it has grown by about 90% in 2018. Additionally, contrary to your expectations, it is not PUBG ruling the roost here in India. The same App Annie report



shows that the top five games downloaded in India are:

- Ludo King
- Subway Surfer
- Temple Run 2
- Candy Crush Sagar
- Temple Run

None of these games are actually known for in-app purchases. They are essentially free to play, where not giving in to the games' in-app purchases doesn't take away from the game itself. Interestingly, battle royale games are nowhere to be seen.

Another area where Indians are leading in a spectacular way is food ordering. Sessions in Food and Drink apps in India have grown by 120% since 2016, with downloads going up by as much as 900%, the highest in the world. This is powered by the growth of food delivery services as well as the rise of cloud kitchens - namely, eateries that have no physical dine-in options, and only sustain via online orders. Additionally, the on-demand delivery ecosystem is also powered by the availability of a young, dynamic and cost-effective workforce. Interestingly, brand-specific QSR (Quick Service Restaurants or fast food) apps have used loyalty programs to make

a lot of inroads around the globe, but the same does not work in India. The top five QSR apps are Dominos Pizza, McDelivery, Pizza Hut, Starbucks India, KFC India, out of which only Starbucks and McDonalds offer loyalty features.

Financial apps tell a similar story. A large part of the Indian population remains unbanked. However, financial apps have brought essential aspects of the banking experience to them without the need to open an actual bank account. Things like money transfer, investment, microloans, even third-party services like utility bill payments are now readily accessible under single payment-app umbrellas.

Video streaming apps are highly talked about whenever the growth story of apps comes up, especially in the Indian context. Globally, people are spending 140% more time in video streaming apps as compared to two years ago. However, in emerging markets like India, that growth is charted higher at 185%. The top five video streaming apps in India by time spent are:

- YouTube
- Hotstar
- JioTV
- Amazon Prime Video
- Voot

India also saw a nearly 600% growth in consumer spend in such apps. However, the players in the space don't exactly remain the same with this metric. While Netflix bags the top position, mostly due to its high subscription rates, Hotstar comes a close second, due to its tie-ups with many TV channels for exclusive content. They're followed by two live streaming platforms BIGO LIVE and Live.me where users can pay to unlock privileges during live streams.

Social media and messaging apps are also growing year on year in India, despite occupying a smaller chunk of the total time spent. Indian users are spending about 40% more time in Social media and messaging apps as compared to a couple of years back. Video is a huge factor in this segment.

While Snapchat and Instagram are a couple of examples of apps that are driving it globally, short video sharing social platforms like Tiktok are ruling the roost in India when it comes to social media. Overall, WhatsApp still retains the first position in this segment. According to a Mood of the Nation (MOTN) survey conducted by Lokniti, WhatsApp usage has grown to 20% and 38% among the rural and urban populations respectively, marking at least a 10% growth over a year.

There are numerous other areas that are responsible for the overall growth of apps in India. For instance, medical apps in India have seen a growth of 65%. India has a low doctor-patient ratio, and mobile apps offering remote access to doctors and medical care via video calls, chats and more are becoming first responders to many medical needs.



With most of the trends out of the way now, let's take a deeper look at what people are downloading the most and where people are spending in high numbers, respectively.

WHY DOES IT WORK?

If you look at the top most downloaded apps in India right now, there are a couple of trends that might jump out to you. As of December 2018, five out of the top 10 apps on the Indian Play Store come from China, up from two at the end of 2017. If you expand the total list to the top 100, you get 44 apps from China. There are Chinese apps beyond the top 100 that have crossed the milestone of a million downloads in India as well.